

14 Comparing and contrasting

Using "as... as" is a very flexible way to make comparisons. You can use it to compare and contrast quantities and qualities of people, objects, situations, and ideas.

- ⚙️ **New language** "As... as" comparisons
- Aa **Vocabulary** Adjective-noun collocations
- 🧩 **New skill** Comparing and contrasting

14.1 KEY LANGUAGE "AS... AS" COMPARISONS

You can use "as... as" with an adjective to compare things that are similar and "not as... as" or "not so... as" to contrast things that are different.



Lisa is **as** tall **as** Marc.



Penny is **not** $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{as} \\ \text{so} \end{array} \right\}$ tall **as** Marc.



14.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES "AS... AS" COMPARISONS

You can modify the "as... as" structure to make it more detailed or to add emphasis.



Emphasizing equality.

Bottled water is **just** as expensive **as** coffee.



Comparing similarity.

The girls were **almost** as loud **as** the boys.



This has a very similar meaning to "almost as" but contrasts the difference rather than comparing the similarity.

The movie is **not quite** as good **as** the book.



Specific degree of difference.

The bike is **half** as long **as** the car.



Emphasizing difference.

The mouse is **nowhere near** as big **as** the bird.

